

SCORE BOARD The Music that they Play

Product	Features	Plugins	File Formats Supported	Web site	File size (MB)	Price (\$)	Rating
WAVE CoolEdit 2000	CD recording, File conversion, Touchup function, Audio effects	Tweaking Toys, Phat	mp3, wav, aif, vox, au, voc, txt, svx	www.syntrillium.com	8.4	69	B+
Goldwave	Independent device control window, Expression evaluator	Pack, Pro Equalizer, Studio Plugin, Audio Cleanup plugin, Direct plugin	wav, aif, mp3, ogg, voc, snd, aif, afc, iff, mat, vox, dwd, smp, sds, txt	www.goldwave.com	0.8	40	B
Sound Forge 5	Updated user interface, Repair tools, CD burning and ripping	None	wma, wmv, asf, wav, vox, snd, rm, raw, pca, ogg,	www.sonicfoundry.com	20	399	A-
Waveflow	MDI (multiple document interface), Filters, Wavelet denoising	Acoustic Mirror, Wavehammer, xfx1, xfx2, xfx3	mp3, mov, ivc, dig, avi, au, aif	www.waveflow.com	1.1	25	B
Wavelab	Frequency analysis, Crossfade looper, Support for 24-bit audio files	None	raw, txt, prn, wav, csv	NA	5.8	394	B-
MIDI Cakewalk 9	Multiple track editing in piano roll, sessions drummer, export to MP3 and real audio	vst, DirectX	wav, aif, au, paf	www.cakewalk.com	12.8	349	B+
Cubase VST5	13 new effects, 32-bit and true-tape recording, Supports 96 KHz recording	vst, DirectX	wrk, bun, wav	www.steinberg.net	11.6	399	B
Evolution Audio	Onscreen keyboard, 256 track support	None	wav, trk, mid	www.evolution.co.uk	0.8	99	B
Midi Maestro	Monophonic MIDI to audio transcription tool, support for direct-show compatible MIDI filters	None	wav	www.midimaestro.com	8.6	99	B

with the help of Wavepipe technology, thus allowing you to apply effects to tracks in real time and while the song is playing.

Cakewalk also provides you with support to connect external devices such as synthesisers to mix your own recordings.

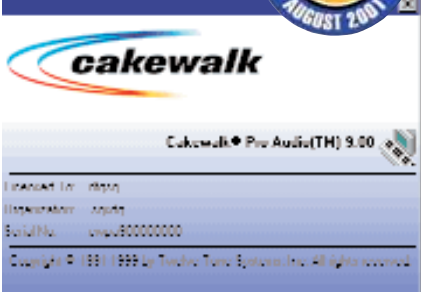
If you are looking for software that is reasonably good, that is low-priced and yet has enough features, then you should opt for Evolution. In terms of features, Cakewalk Pro 9 is a good choice because of the plugins and advanced audio effects and

editing tools that are incorporated into it. But if you want high-end features and price is no constraint, then you should not settle for anything less than Cakewalk Pro 9 or Cubase VST 5.

CONCLUSION

Most of the software that we tested offered good features and new enhancements. But the most impressive among the Wave editing software was **Sound Forge 5**, the winner in this comparison. The software included some great plugins and features that were really useful. The interface too was easy to work with and due to this, editing was a breeze. Cooledit 2000 was very close with loads of enhancements but it missed some useful features such as CD

burning, which was offered by Sound Forge 5.



Cakewalk Pro: The right choice for Midi

In the MIDI comparison there were software such as Cubase VST5 that offered great features and almost everything that a user would need for MIDI editing. But **Cakewalk Pro9** is very good choice and proved to be a true winner because of the great features and the ease of use—even novice users will find editing with this a delight.

Ease of use was one area where Cubase was found to be tricky because even though people already working with MIDI softwares will find it amazing due to its features, novice users will have to spend time to get used to the software.■



Sound Forge: Your wave file companion

Making Music on your PC

Your MIDI software can be used to make your own music. The setup is quite simple. You should have a soundcard with a MIDI input, a MIDI cable, a mike (if you want to record your own voice), and a MIDI editing software such as Cakewalk. If you want to record musical notes from a synthesizer, all you have to do is connect one end of the y cable to the output port of the synthesizer and the other end to the MIDI input port in the soundcard. If you want to record voice, then the mike should be plugged into the soundcard.